Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 4
Reading • 2 min
✓ Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books
✓ Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900
Reading • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Photo Books
Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work
✓ Photo Series
Reading • 13 min
✓ Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many
✓ One from Many
Reading • 8 min
✓ Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min
✓ Optional Mid-Course Survey
Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 5
Reading • 2 min
✓ Artwork Spotlight: Hank Willis Thomas's UNBRANDED series
Reading • 2 min
✓ Hank Willis Thomas on the Role of Advertising Images
Video • 3 min

Part II: Re-envisioning History
✓ Constructing History
Reading • 4 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Challenging History
Reading • 6 min
✓ Hear More: Carrie Mae Weems on From Here I Saw What Happened and I Cried, 1995–96
Video • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Walid Raad of The Atlas Group on My neck is thinner than a hair: Engines, 1996–2001
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Harrell Fletcher on The American War, 2005
Video • 4 min

Part III: Envisioning Selves and Stereotypes
✓ Constructing Personal Narratives
Reading • 10 min
✓ Hear More: Iñaki Bonillas on Constructing Identities
Video • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Eva Respini on Cindy Sherman. Untitled Film Stills. 1977–80
Video • 1 min
✓ Hear More: David Alekhuogie on To Live and Die in LA, 2019
Video • 4 min

Part IV: Review and Respond
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Pictures of People

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 6
Reading • 2 min
✓ Artwork Spotlight: Katy Grannan's Portraits
Reading • 2 min
✓ Katy Grannan on Taking Portraits
Video • 3 min

Part II: Between Subject and Object
✓ Exploring Agency
Reading • 4 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Susan Meiselas on Carnival Strippers, 1973–75
Video • 5 min
○ **Self-Possession**
Reading • 4 min

Part III: Individuals and Types
○ Performing Identity
Reading • 7 min
○ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
○ Hear More: Akram Zaatari on After They Got the Right to Arms. Fourteen young men posing with guns, early 1970s/2006
Video • 6 min
○ Hear More: Stephanie Syjuco on Cargo Cults, 2013–16
Video • 2 min

Part IV: Strangers and Friends
○ Loved Ones
Reading • 7 min
○ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
○ Hear More: Tina Barney on Sunday New York Times, 1982
Video • 1 min
○ Hear More: Deana Lawson on Roxie and Raquel, 2010
Video • 1 min
○ Hear More: Maria Antelman on Puzzlers, 2020
Video • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
○ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • 30 min
○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
○ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Self-Possession

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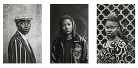
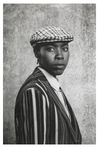
Zanele Muholi



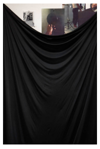
Zanele Muholi. *Sunday Francis Mdlankomo, Vosloorus, Johannesburg*; *Xana Nyilenda, Newtown, Johannesburg*; *Lynette Mokhooa, KwaThema Community Hall, Springs, Johannesburg*. All 2011. Gelatin silver prints, each approx. 30 1/16 × 19 3/4" (76.4 × 50.1 cm). All The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Bernard Lumpkin and Carmine Boccuzzi in honor of the Friends of Education of The Museum of Modern Art, and The Photography Council Fund. © 2020 Zanele Muholi



Zanele Muholi. *Sunday Francis Mdlankomo, Vosloorus, Johannesburg*. 2011. Gelatin silver prints, 30 1/16 × 19 3/4" (76.4 × 50.1 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Bernard Lumpkin and Carmine Boccuzzi in honor of the Friends of Education of The Museum of Modern Art. © 2020 Zanele Muholi

Zanele Muholi began their Faces and Phases project in 2006, merging art and activism into a practice they call "visual activism." Muholi's growing portfolio portrays members of the Black South African Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender, and Intersex (LGBTI) community, which has been violently discriminated against. Their black-and-white portraits capture a "face-to-face confrontation" with their subjects and "present our existence and resistance through positive imagery." Muholi has said, "We should be counted and certainly counted on to write our own history and validate our existence. We should not feel that somebody owes us these liberties. …we deserve recognition, respect, validation, and to have publications that mark and trace our existence."

Paul Mpagi Sepuya



Paul Mpagi Sepuya. *A Sitting for Matthew*. 2015. Pigmented inkjet print, 51 × 34" (129.5 × 86.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Paul Mpagi Sepuya

"I don't think desire can be separated from…photography regardless of whether or not there is a human body in the photograph," says artist Paul Mpagi Sepuya. "Photography is a technology that produces for us images that wish to be seen. Photographs wouldn't exist if we didn't desire them to, whether that desire comes from lust or curiosity." Sepuya's work is the product of relationships. Collaborating with communities of artists and queer-identified people, his work often features imagery of people he knows.

In *A Sitting for Matthew*, the layered images at the top include photos of Sepuya that served as source material for a portrait made by fellow artist Matthew Morrocco. Sepuya commonly integrates mirrors, tripods, and cascading drapes into his images as references to the photography studio space—a site connected to ideas of free expression. Sepuya's work is also characterized by fragmentation: cropped limbs, hidden features, and uncertain relationships between bodies. His images create a sense of ambiguity that speaks to the "complications of portraiture" and invite viewers to consider their relationship to the work. "I'm interested in the viewer being in front of, or perhaps desiring, a very intimate picture, yet wholly outside of it," he says.

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